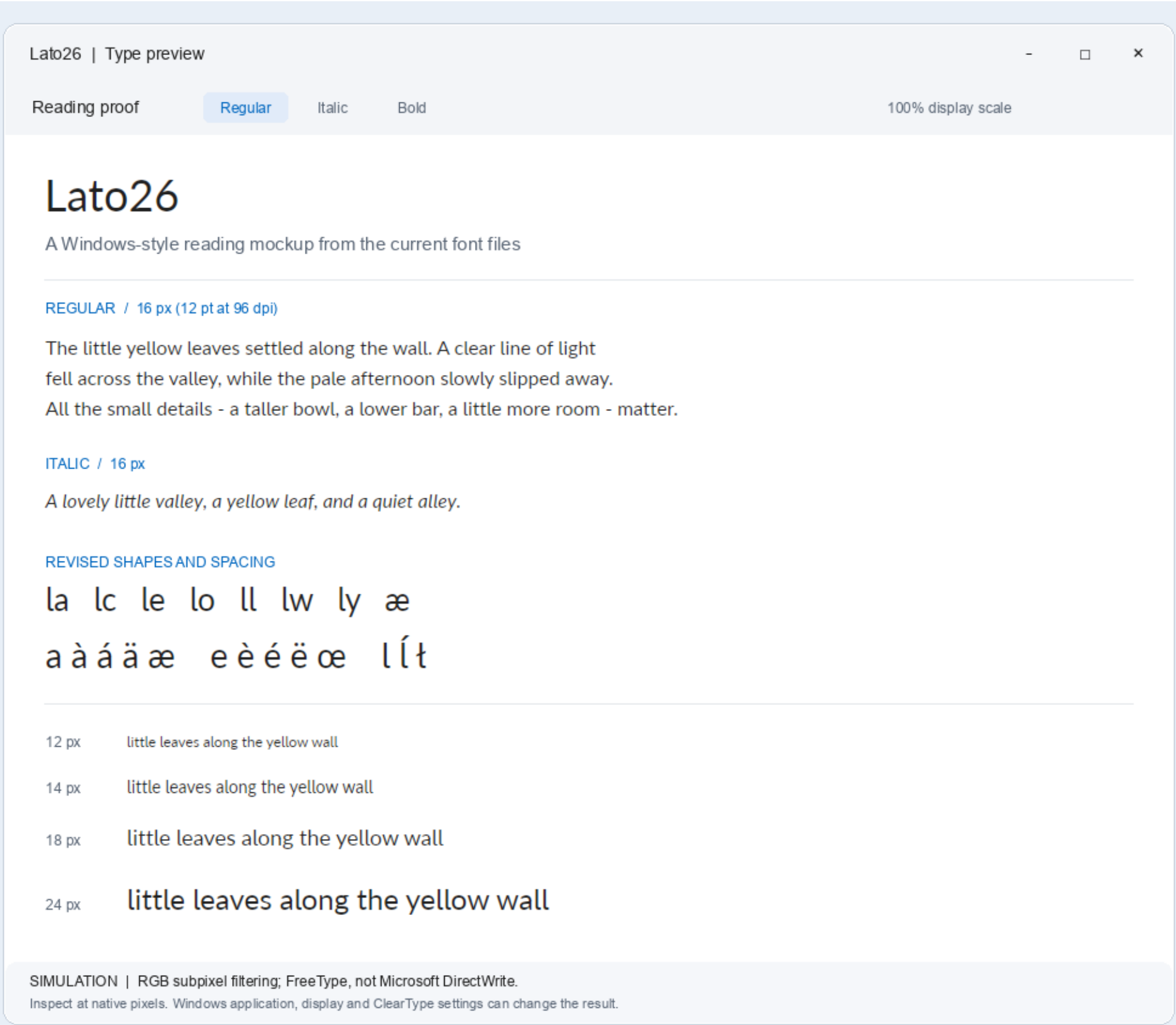
Lato26 / Windows-style reading proof

100% scale. Text samples come from the current Lato26 TTFs.



A filtered RGB approximation, not a Windows 11 / DirectWrite capture.
Use the PNG viewer at Native pixels for screen judgments; PDF viewers may resample these raster proofs.

Weight and italic comparisons

Nine weights, upright and italic; 16 px and 13 px samples.

Lato26 / all weights

RGB subpixel approximation at 16 px and 13 px; 100% display scale.

Current TTF outlines and kerning. This is not a Windows screenshot.

	UPRIGHT	ITALIC
Hairline	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Thin	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Light	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Regular	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Medium	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Semibold	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Bold	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Heavy	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*
Black	la lc le lo ll lw ly æ little leaves along the yellow wall	*la lc le lo ll lw ly æ* *little leaves along the yellow wall*

Small sizes expose hinting differences as well as the outline changes.

Simulation settings: RGB stripes / five-tap LCD filter / blending gamma 1.8.

A filtered RGB approximation, not a Windows 11 / DirectWrite capture.
Use the PNG viewer at Native pixels for screen judgments; PDF viewers may resample these raster proofs.

Subpixels and grayscale

Fixed 4x nearest-neighbor enlargements of 16 px text.

The same pixels, enlarged

16 px type at 100% scale. Each panel uses 4x nearest-neighbor enlargement.

RGB edges reveal subpixel rendering; the grayscale comparison uses the same gamma.

Regular / RGB subpixel approximation



Regular / grayscale antialiasing



Italic / RGB subpixel approximation



Italic / grayscale antialiasing



The enlarged panels show pixel structure, not the perceived appearance at reading size.

A filtered RGB approximation, not a Windows 11 / DirectWrite capture.

Use the PNG viewer at Native pixels for screen judgments; PDF viewers may resample these raster proofs.

Display scaling

Fresh rasterization at 100%, 125%, 150%, and 200% scale.

Display scaling / 16 px text

Each row is rasterized again at its physical pixel size, not enlarged from a 100% image.

100% display scale / 16 physical pixels per em

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

125% display scale / 20 physical pixels per em

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

150% display scale / 24 physical pixels per em

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

200% display scale / 32 physical pixels per em

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

little leaves along the yellow wall · la lc le lo ll lw ly æ

All rows are displayed at the same pixel-to-image ratio here; higher-scale rows are physically larger.

For equal logical window sizes, compare the separate mockup images in the viewer.

Lato26 uses ttfautohint 1.3 with the exact engine settings of released Lato 2.015.
Method: native TTF bytecode, FreeType LCD-style filtering, HarfBuzz shaping, gamma 1.8.
References: freetype.org/freetype2/docs/reference/ft2-lcd_rendering.html and Microsoft DirectWrite documentation.

Embedded TrueType instructions

Historical/current builds at the same size; the current l has a smaller bowl and advance.

Lato 2.015 hinting / before and after

Historical / current builds. Hinting, outlines and spacing differ. 16 px text, enlarged 3x.

PREVIOUS LATO26 HINTS	LATO26 / 2.015 RECIPE
Light Upright	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	a e æ l le lo lw ly
Light Italic	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	*a e æ l le lo lw ly*
Regular Upright	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	a e æ l le lo lw ly
Regular Italic	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	*a e æ l le lo lw ly*
Bold Upright	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	**a e æ l le lo lw ly**
Bold Italic	
a e æ l le lo lw ly	***a e æ l le lo lw ly***

Rendering remains a FreeType RGB approximation; native Windows/DirectWrite validation is still separate.

All 20 desktop TTFs now use the Lato 2.015 hinting recipe, replacing the previous hint programs.
The recipe reproduces all original glyph programs and global hint tables in the 18 reference fonts exactly.
Current l pairs preserve the established special-pair gaps with the smaller bowl.

Bold a / corrected hinting

A focused comparison at 12-20 px, including the reported 16 px size.

Bold a / bowl-top hint correction

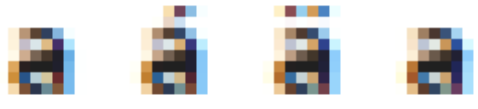
The same outlines and spacing; 6x nearest-neighbor enlargement of the actual pixels.

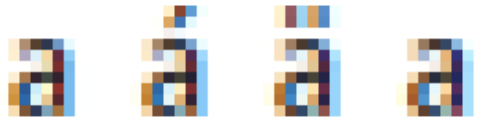
The correction also applies to 33 matching accented and Cyrillic forms.

EARLIER AUTOHINT PASS

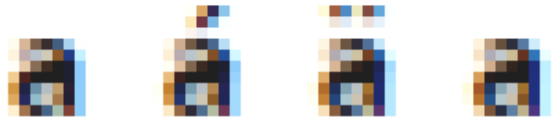
LATO26 / 2.015 + BOWL CONTROL

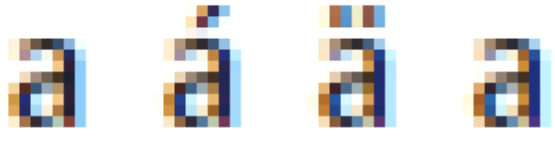
12 px





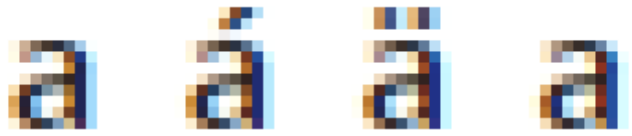
14 px





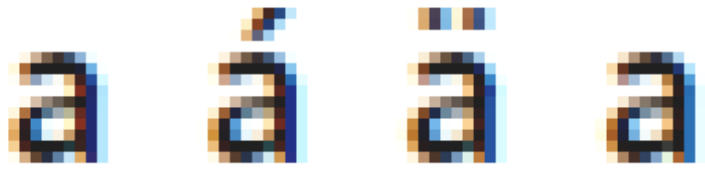
16 px / reported size





18 px





20 px





16 px bowl-top edge separation at the join: 2.23 px before, 1.30 px corrected (outline: 1.21 px).

FreeType RGB approximation. The new font uses the same hinting engine and settings as Lato 2.015.

The bowl control keeps the top stroke thin; a final point link preserves the arch-to-stem overlap.
The correction covers the Bold a and 33 matching accented/Cyrillic forms, without moving outline points.
All styles use the released 2.015 recipe; italic a retains its existing outline and receives fresh instructions.

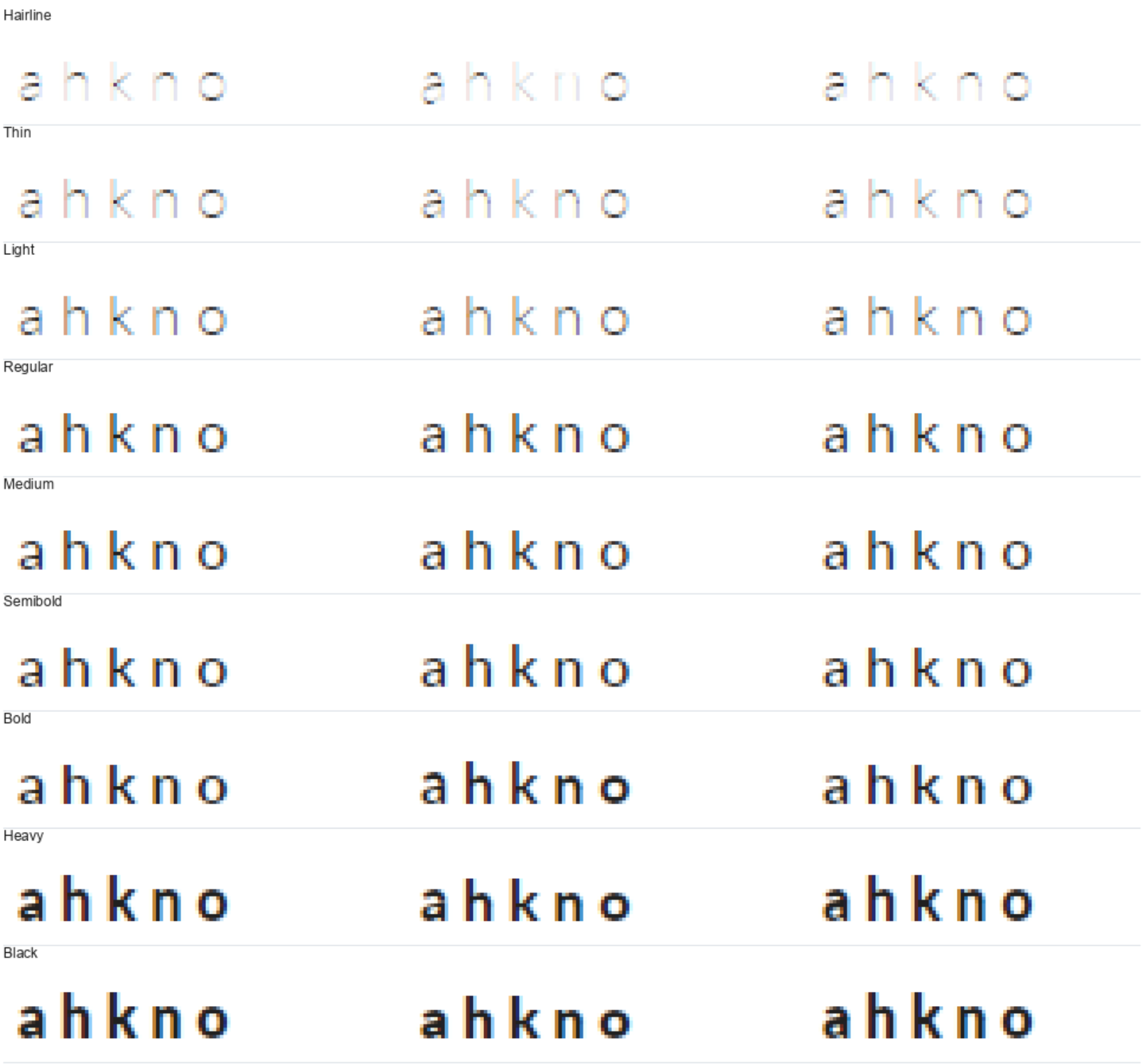
Installed Lato comparison / Upright

Lato 2.015 reference, original repository hinting, and Lato26 using the released hinting recipe.

Upright / released hinting restored

16 px type enlarged 3x. Each file executes its own embedded TrueType instructions.

The italic a is unchanged by our outline edits; the upright a has the enlarged bowl.



Lato26 keeps our outlines and spacing. Instructions are regenerated with the exact Lato 2.015 recipe.

Installed fonts: Lato 2.015, released 2015-08-06, 3,023 glyphs; repository exports: Lato 3.100.
Current Lato26 keeps our revised outlines; small design differences can still produce different pixels.
All samples use the same renderer, pixel size, RGB filter and gamma; this is not a Windows capture.

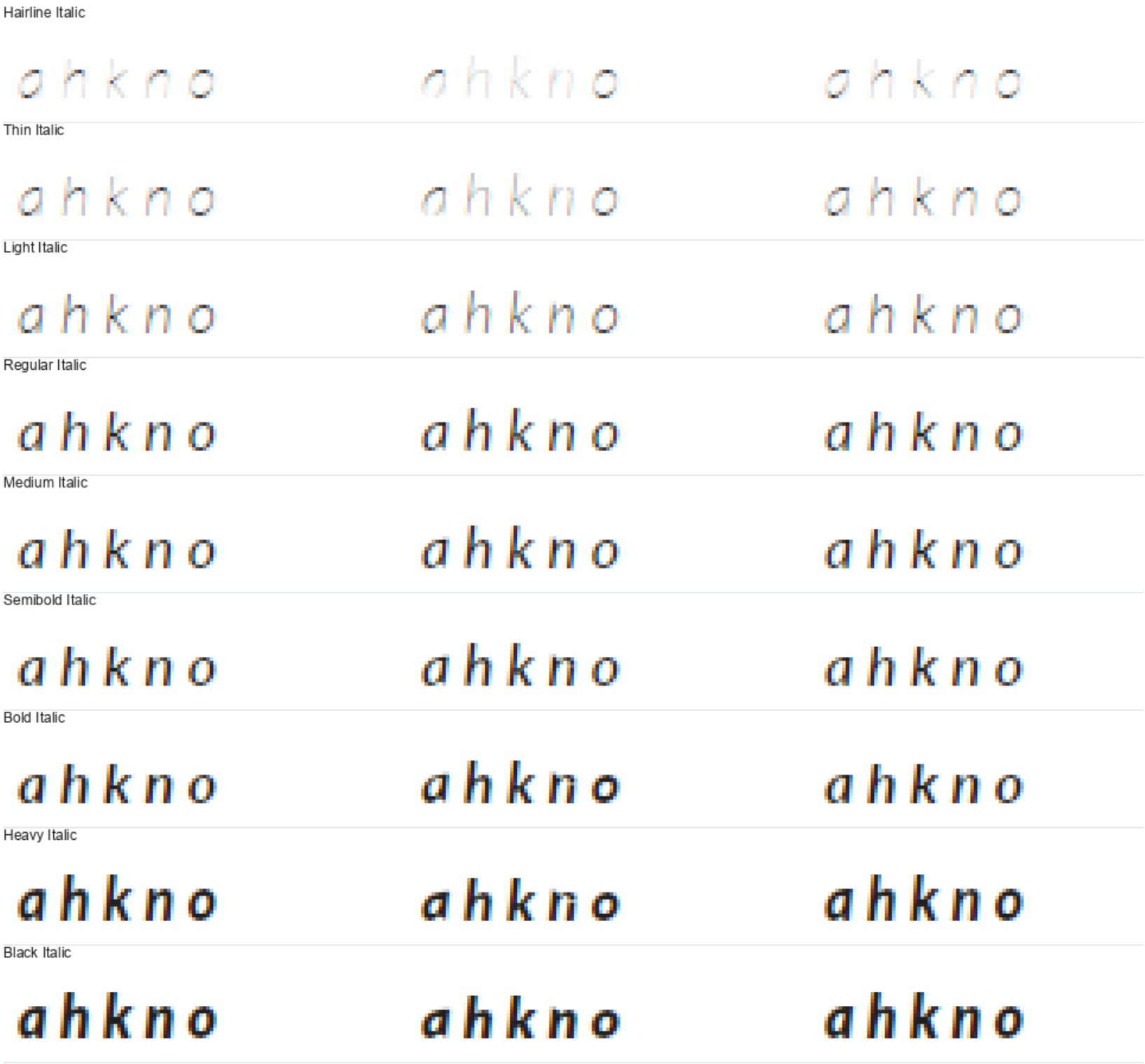
Installed Lato comparison / Italic

Lato 2.015 reference, original repository hinting, and Lato26 using the released hinting recipe.

Italic / released hinting restored

16 px type enlarged 3x. Each file executes its own embedded TrueType instructions.

The italic a is unchanged by our outline edits; the upright a has the enlarged bowl.

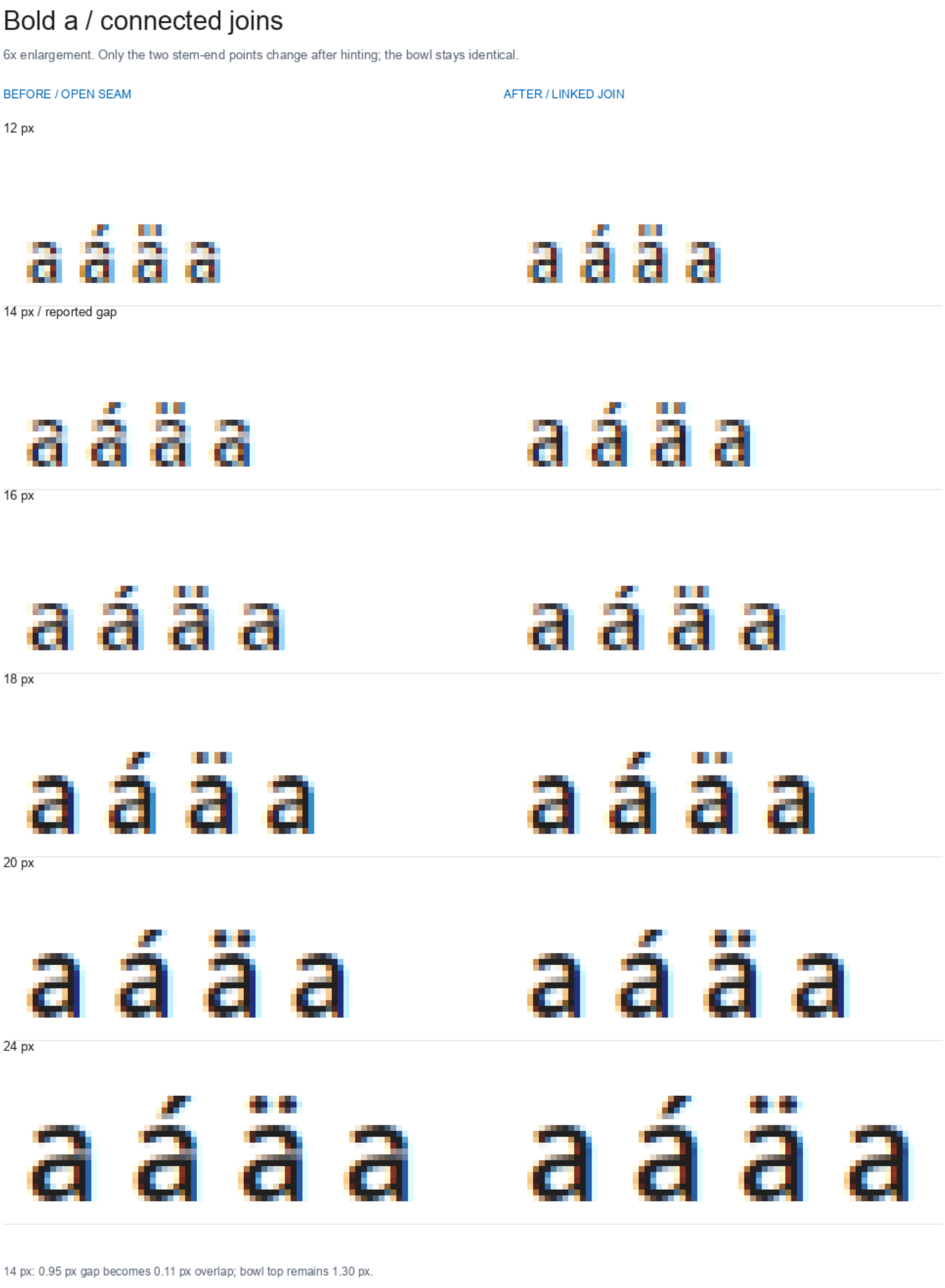


Lato26 keeps our outlines and spacing. Instructions are regenerated with the exact Lato 2.015 recipe.

Installed fonts: Lato 2.015, released 2015-08-06, 3,023 glyphs; repository exports: Lato 3.100.
Current Lato26 keeps our revised outlines; small design differences can still produce different pixels.
All samples use the same renderer, pixel size, RGB filter and gamma; this is not a Windows capture.

Bold a / repaired joins

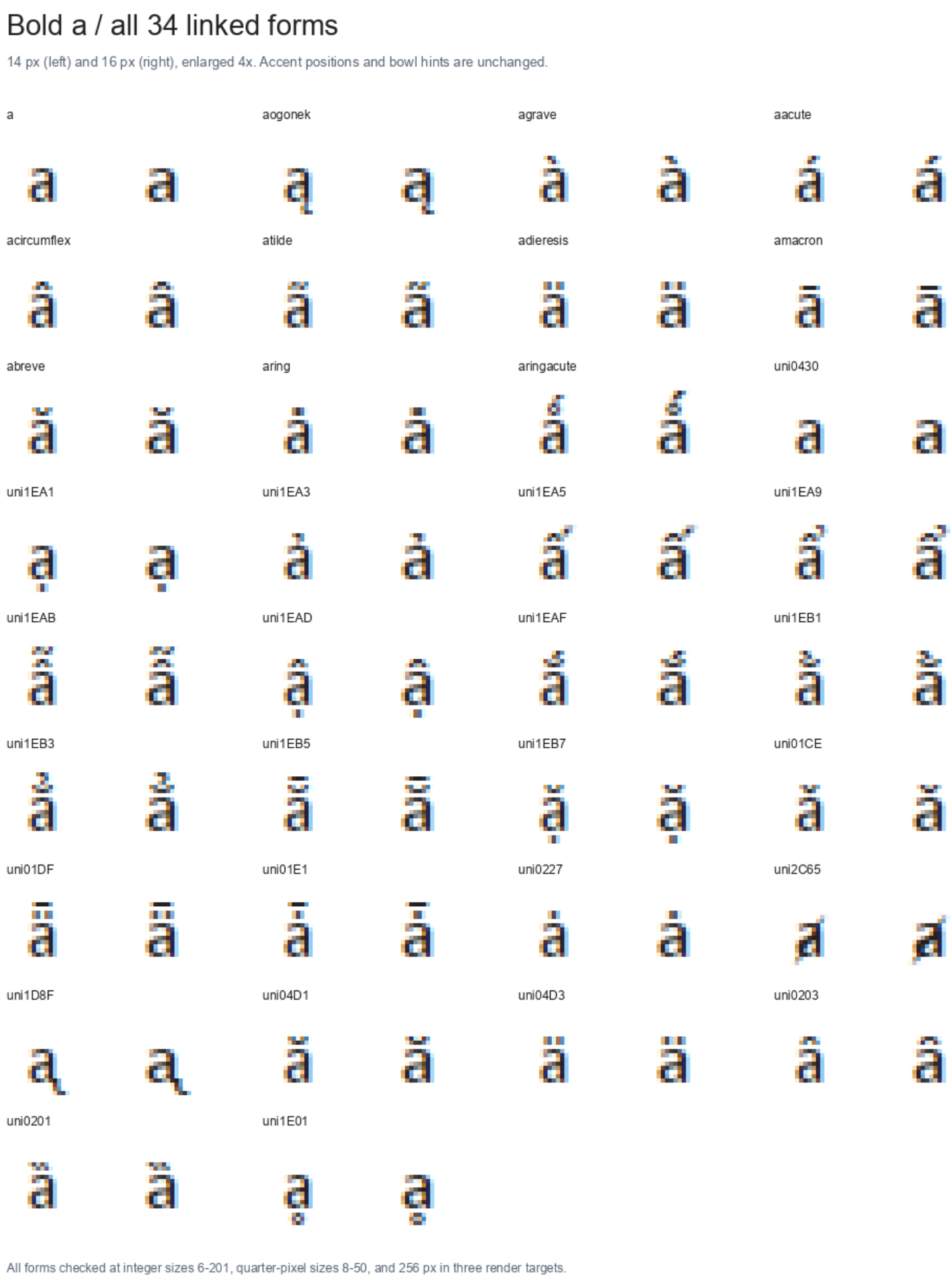
Before and after at 12-24 px, including the reported 14 px gap.



The two stem-end points retain at least their original overlap with the upper arch at every tested size.
Bowl, arch-curve and accent point positions are identical to the preceding thin-bowl correction.
Native grayscale, monochrome and LCD checks cover all 34 forms, including fractional pixel sizes.

Bold a / accented and related forms

All 34 affected forms at 14 and 16 px; enlarged 4x for inspection.



32,946 glyph/size/render-target cases passed: connected joins and unchanged bowl/accents.
The a outlines and accent positions are unchanged; the l was revised separately.
FreeType RGB approximation; PDF viewers can resample the pixels.